

RANK-4	S.P. JAIN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT & RESEARCH
OVERALL SCORE	847.7
PLACEMENT PERFORMANCE	All students placed, with a median salary of ₹30.5 lakh per annum
CAMPUS EXPERIENCE	- Recently opened a brand-new, state-of-the-art recreation centre, designed to promote holistic well-being and foster community connection on campus - The 45-acre campus in Mumbai gives it access to the city's diversity going well beyond business
NEW INITIATIVES	Successfully hosted the International Technology and Societal Impact Conference

A NEW AGE

36 | From a business school perspective, there are many opinions on how AI has changed the landscape. Nagaraj chooses the advent of the internet and social media to drive home the point.

“They were not disruptive to education and certainly not so quickly. However, AI is a very different proposition,” he says. Moving to Gen AI, Nagaraj, himself an engineering graduate from the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay, thinks it has to be the fastest-adopted technology in recent history, where time has been compressed.

All this puts the onus on an institute to make its curriculum even more relevant in the new era. According to Nagaraj, the impact of AI can be understood in two ways. The first is how it makes a difference in practice, encompassing areas like marketing and supply chain management.

The other piece, and perhaps the more important one, revolves around how AI is used in the class-

room. “This must be understood by both students and professors. AI cannot be taught, and the focus is on how it changes things,” he says. At the same time, Nagaraj is clear that AI is compromising the process of learning, though the thinking has changed. “A year ago, the discussion was on how to restrict the use of AI. Now, there is a realisation that it cannot be controlled and, therefore, the question is how do we change the way we teach?”

Here is where learning as a social activity comes in. Nagaraj cites the case study approach, now well-established in most business schools, in the absence of AI. He believes that leads to first principles thinking.

“You then bring in AI. The objective is to have high-quality blended learning,” he says.

THINK DIFFERENT

At SPJIMR, the focus over the last year has been on innovation. It is an area that excites Nagaraj, who insists on linking that to societal

impact. The institute defines “wise innovation” as one that is purposeful and done for the right reasons. It goes beyond novelty and requires a nuanced understanding of innovation’s broader impact and implications.

For that to materialise, the most fundamental change is in the curriculum. For him, introducing new courses like systems design and systems thinking has been key.

Apart from this, research is another facet. In that direction, SPJIMR hosted a conference in 2025 to bring academics, doctoral scholars, research fellows, practitioners and policymakers together. The objective is to explore how organisations can leverage technology to shape a responsible landscape and sustainable future. To Nagaraj, what can be done for societal impact is most critical. “At any point through this process, that link between innovation and societal impact must be strong.”

Being housed in Mumbai, India’s financial capital, is a significant strategic advantage for the institute. The access to large companies across sectors has stood it in good stead for many years now. There is a constant endeavour to invest in infrastructure, the classrooms are set in a modern environment, which includes video conferencing platforms used for online classes, hybrid meetings and webinars. The job at the end of the two-year programme is only part of what SPJIMR stands for.

Impact is a phrase that Nagaraj repeatedly uses throughout our conversation. If that percolates to each student, it will make him and the entire SPJIMR staff a happy bunch. **BT**

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